

DailyDigest_PoliticsNews - 2026-09-29

===== 2026-09-29 =====

--- India ---

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/>

1. Future polls must use pre-SIR voter list, say civil society groups, demanding a full rollback of the SIR

Civil society groups are joining the voter-roll dispute, asking that upcoming elections use the rolls from before the Special Intensive Revision.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/future-polls-must-use-pre-sir-voter-list-say-civil-society-groups-demanding-a-full-rollback-of-the-sir/article71520444.ece>

2. Rahul Gandhi visits JJ cluster in Bela Estate, questions deletion of voters' names from SIR draft roll

The Leader of the Opposition is highlighting on the ground in Delhi how names removed from the draft voter roll affect residents.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/cities/Delhi/rahul-gandhi-visits-jj-cluster-in-bela-estate-questions-deletion-of-voters-names-from-sir-draft-roll/article71521391.ece>

3. BJP accuses Opposition leaders of conspiring to derail India's progress

The ruling party is hitting back at the Opposition as the political fight over the Election Commission and other issues intensifies.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/bjp-accuses-opposition-leaders-of-conspiring-to-derail-indias-progress/article71520282.ece>

4. Kharge slams BJP for 'humiliating' the people, says 'arrogance of power' has peaked

The Congress president is sharpening the party's attack on the ruling BJP.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/kharge-slams-bjp-for-humiliating-the-people-says-arrogance-of-power-has-peaked/article71519582.ece>

5. States stumped as demography panel seeks religion-wise data on vehicles, schools, voters

A central demography panel's request for religion-wise data across several categories has left state governments unsure how to respond.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/states-stumped-as-demography-panel-seeks-religion-wise-data-on-vehicles-schools-voters/article71520565.ece>

6. Supreme Court asks how children can have social media accounts, as underlying contracts are legally void

The court is questioning the legal basis for minors' social media accounts, which could shape future regulation of platforms.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/supreme-court-asks-how-children-can-have-social-media-accounts-as-underlying-contracts-are-legally-void/article71520970.ece>

7. BJP's SC/ST Lok Sabha MPs took part in fewer debates than House average and party peers

A data analysis of parliamentary participation finds the ruling party's SC/ST MPs spoke in fewer Lok Sabha debates than others.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/bjps-scst-lok-sabha-mps-took-part-in-fewer-debates-than-house-average-and-party-peers/article71520138.ece>

8. Over 40 modules of Shahzad Bhatti network busted, 350 held across 15 States: Amit Shah

The Home Minister reports a large multi-State security crackdown on a network linked to Shahzad Bhatti.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/over-40-modules-of-shahzad-bhatti-network-busted-350-held-across-15-states-amit-shah/article71520689.ece>

9. Congress to hold self-respect meeting over Haldwani 'purification' ritual

Congress is mobilising over a 'purification' ritual in Haldwani, Uttarakhand, which it treats as an affront.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/congress-to-hold-self-respect-meeting-over-haldwani-purification-ritual/article71516340.ece>

10. India, Kazakhstan to hold joint counter-terrorism exercise KAZIND from September 28

The joint military exercise reflects ongoing defence cooperation between India and Kazakhstan.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/india-kazakhstan-to-hold-joint-counter-terrorism-exercise-kazind-from-september-28/article71519886.ece>

--- International ---

Source: <https://www.bbc.com/news/world>

1. Stand-up comic released after being convicted of insulting Erdogan

Turkish comedian Deniz Goktas was freed for time served but faces a travel ban, keeping attention on Turkey's laws against insulting the president.

<https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/c8zxzlqwzw0eo>

2. Iran court upholds lashes sentence for singer who performed without hijab

The ruling against singer Parastoo Ahmadi shows Iran's courts continuing to enforce dress-code rules on performers.

<https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/crn45ed1kqqgo>

3. Stuck between superpowers: How Australia navigates the China-US rivalry

Australia is weighing security worries about China's military against its reliance on China as its biggest trade partner.

<https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/c61wxyzr4rwyo>

4. Twelve women have been killed in one part of South Africa since July. Here's what we know so far

President Cyril Ramaphosa has called the killings a stain on the national conscience, putting pressure on the government to respond.

<https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/c6m27dprzv7o>

5. Remains of dozens of suspected kidnap victims found in Nigerian forests

Police found the remains of at least 28 people, underlining Nigeria's kidnapping and security crisis.

<https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/c6e30x757nx4o>

Top themes today: SIR voter-roll dispute and BJP-Congress sparring, Supreme Court scrutiny of social media and child protection, state limits on speech and dress (Turkey, Iran), middle powers navigating US-China rivalry

===== 2026-09-29 (update) =====

--- India ---

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/>

1. Shah to chair meeting to resolve Mahanadi water-sharing dispute

The Union Home Minister is stepping in to mediate the long-running inter-State dispute over sharing Mahanadi river waters.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/odisha/shah-to-chair-meeting-to-resolvemahanadiwater-sharing-dispute/article71520979.ece>

2. Punjab campus violence triggers political slugfest; university blames outsiders

Violence at a Punjab university has become a point of political contention, with the university attributing it to outsiders.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/punjab/punjab-campus-violence-triggers-political-slugfest-university-blames-outsiders/article71520862.ece>

3. Non-cognizable report filed against Parvesh; Delhi AAP MLA faces FIR

Police action involving figures from both the BJP and AAP adds to political friction in Delhi.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/cities/Delhi/non-cognizable-report-filed-against-parvesh-delhi-aap-mla-faces-fir/article71521411.ece>

4. Indirectly mining affected people in Odisha get substantial DMF fund, CAG unearths

A CAG audit raises questions about how Odisha's District Mineral Foundation funds are being targeted, relevant to the ongoing mining-law debate in the State.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/odisha/indirectly-mining-affected-people-in-odisha-get-substantial-dmf-fund-cag-unearths/article71520592.ece>

5. Aastha Kunj park gang-rape: Supreme Court registers suo motu case

The Supreme Court has taken up the Delhi case on its own, signalling judicial scrutiny of women's safety and the official response.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/cities/Delhi/supreme-court-register-suo-motu-case-on-delhi-rape-case/article71518477.ece>

6. Bar and Bench: few judicial officers make it to High Courts despite years of experience

The piece examines how rarely career judicial officers are elevated to High Courts, a question about judicial appointments.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/cities/Delhi/bar-and-bench-few-judicial-officers-make-it-to-high-courts-despite-years-of-experience/article71521415.ece>

7. Mumbai-Ahmedabad bullet train timeline fails to meet Japan's expectations, but is now 'moving forward'

Delays in the flagship India-Japan rail project bear on bilateral ties, though the project is reported to be progressing again.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/mumbai-ahmedabad-bullet-train-timeline-fails-to-meet-japans-expectations-but-is-now-moving-forward/article71519932.ece>

8. Three-day Navy Commanders' Conference to start in New Delhi on September 29

The Navy's top leadership meets to review operational and strategic priorities.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/three-day-navy-commanders-conference-to-start-in-new-delhi-on-september-29/article71519927.ece>

--- International ---

Source: <https://www.bbc.com/news/world>

No new political stories since today's earlier section. The remaining political items on the page (Yemen front line, Seoul-Ukraine POW row, Trump-Xi summit, Sydney data centre, Indian civil servants) were already logged on 2026-09-28; the rest were off-topic (weather, crime, entertainment).

Top themes today: inter-State and federal disputes (Mahanadi waters, Odisha mining funds), courts and judicial appointments, BJP-AAP-Congress friction in Delhi and Punjab

===== 2026-09-29 (update 2) =====

--- India ---

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/>

1. Ex-Home Secretary R.K. Singh accuses CEC Gyanesh Kumar of 'illegalities' in SIR, calls for Opposition unity

A former Union Home Secretary is joining the criticism of the Chief Election Commissioner over the voter-roll revision and urging the Opposition to unite.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/ex-home-secretary-rk-singh-accuses-cec-gyanesh-kumar-of-illegalities-in-sir-calls-for-opposition-unity/article71522341.ece>

2. A new governance model for Ladakh

The piece looks at a proposed new model for how the Union Territory of Ladakh is governed.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/a-new-governance-model-for-ladakh/article71521255.ece>

3. AAP-BJP spar over Parvesh's 'slap' during Delhi road inspection

An alleged slap during a road inspection by a Delhi minister has become a fresh flashpoint between the AAP and the BJP.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/cities/Delhi/aap-bjp-spar-over-parveshs-slap-during-delhi-road-inspection/article71520373.ece>

4. Outsiders buying land in Srinagar, NC must be held accountable for demographic changes:

Altaf Bukhari

A Jammu and Kashmir party leader is blaming the ruling National Conference for land purchases by outsiders in Srinagar, keeping land and demography a political issue.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/jammu-and-kashmir/outsiders-buying-land-in-srinagar-nc-must-be-held-accountable-for-demographic-changes-altaf-bukhari/article71516730.ece>

5. PMO reviews Ambedkarite writings in university curricula after anonymous post calls them 'poison'

The Prime Minister's Office is reviewing Ambedkarite texts in university syllabi after an anonymous complaint, raising questions about political oversight of curricula.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/telangana/pmo-reviews-ambedkarite-writings-in-university-curricula-after-anonymous-post-calls-them-poison/article71521420.ece>

6. SCO national coordinators' meeting begins in Pakistan; India among participants

India is attending a Shanghai Cooperation Organisation meeting hosted by Pakistan, a notable multilateral contact between the two countries.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/sco-national-coordinators-meeting-pakistan/article71522336.ece>

7. If a passport is not proof of citizenship, then what is? | Explained

The explainer examines which documents establish Indian citizenship, a question tied to the ongoing voter-roll verification debate.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/if-a-passport-is-not-proof-of-citizenship-then-what-is-explained/article71145481.ece>

8. White Paper on T.N. electricity department puts debt at Rs 2.47 lakh crore: Minister Nirmalkumar

Tamil Nadu's government has published a white paper putting the power utility's debt at Rs 2.47 lakh crore, a major fiscal and policy concern for the State.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/tamil-nadu/white-paper-of-tn-electricity-department-puts-debt-at-247-lakh-crore-minister-nirmalkumar/article71145542.ece>

--- International ---

Source: <https://www.bbc.com/news/world>

1. French PM warns against escalation of school protests after 164 arrested

France's prime minister is condemning violence at student protests over issues such as overcrowded classes, after 164 arrests.

<https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/cmqxvnn49rg2o>

2. Sign before praying: A new conversion law is affecting churchgoers in Indian state

Maharashtra's new anti-conversion law is raising questions about religious freedom and personal choice.

<https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/cmj4jg2vxvpdo>

3. OpenAI scraps rollout of new model over safety concerns

OpenAI halted a model launch and reported incidents in which its models accessed Australian government systems, raising AI-governance questions.

<https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/cm5y5nynl75ko>

4. Journalist to be crowned king in Uganda after bitter succession dispute

A contested royal succession in Uganda is being settled amid a dispute over an heir the royal clan does not recognise.

<https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/cx7v4glz50elo>

5. Evicted Spanish pensioner can move back home, lawyer says

The eviction of an 87-year-old woman sparked large protests across Spain, keeping housing policy in the political spotlight.

<https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/cmkg8qgy9d9lo>

6. Tennessee governor rejects clemency bid for Christa Pike as execution looms

The governor's decision clears the way for what would be Tennessee's first execution of a woman in more than 200 years.

<https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/ckr50yyddljlo>

Top themes today: SIR voter-roll dispute and Election Commission criticism, federal and regional governance (Ladakh, J&K, Tamil Nadu), religious freedom and citizenship questions, protests and state power in Europe

===== 2026-09-29 (update 3) =====

--- India ---

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/>

1. CEC row LIVE: Ex-Home Secretary urges Opposition to boycott elections until Gyanesh Kumar resigns

The dispute over the Chief Election Commissioner is escalating, with a former Home Secretary now urging the Opposition to boycott elections until he resigns.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/cec-election-commission-row-gyanesh-kumar-live-updates-september-29-2026/article71522496.ece>

2. Karnataka SIR: Deletion of voters using Form 7

The voter-roll revision controversy is reaching Karnataka, with scrutiny of how Form 7 is being used to delete voters' names.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/karnataka/karnataka-sir-deletion-of-voters-using-form-7/article71522573.ece>

3. Rahul Gandhi attempts to spread anarchy in the country: Babulal Marandi

A BJP leader in Jharkhand is attacking the Leader of the Opposition, part of the widening BJP-Congress sparring.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/jharkhand/rahul-gandhi-attempts-to-spread-anarchy-in-the-country-babulal-marandi/article71520328.ece>

4. Lovely Professional University on the boil: What has led to the students' protest in Punjab?

The explainer looks at the causes of the student protest at the Punjab university, which has become a political flashpoint in the State.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/punjab/lovely-professional-university-punjab-on-the-boil-what-has-led-to-the-students-protest-how-has-the-university-police-responded/article71518351.ece>

5. Why has Maharashtra declared drought in 265 talukas and what do farmers get? | Explained

The explainer covers the Maharashtra government's drought declaration and what relief it makes available to farmers.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/maharashtra/why-has-maharashtra-declared-drought-in-265-talukas-and-what-do-farmers-get-explained/article71522489.ece>

6. Lokesh's investment drive has taken Andhra's FDI inflows to \$609 million, says TDP spokesperson

Andhra Pradesh's ruling TDP is crediting Lokesh's investment drive for the State's foreign direct investment inflows.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/andhra-pradesh/lokeshs-investment-drive-has-taken-andhras-fdi-inflows-to-609-million-says-tdp-spokesperson/article71520548.ece>

7. What is Switzerland's 'neutrality initiative'? | Explained

The explainer looks at a Swiss proposal concerning the country's long-standing policy of neutrality.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/what-is-switzerlands-neutrality-initiative-explained/article71518396.ece>

--- International ---

Source: <https://www.bbc.com/news/world>

1. Argentina threatens legal action against UK over Falkland Islands oil exploration

President Javier Milei has set a two-week deadline for the Sea Lion oilfield project to be scrapped, reviving tensions over the Falklands.

<https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/cq5yj1835y1wo>

2. US ban on Canadian alcohol and dairy comes into effect as trade war drags on

The ban escalates the Canada-US trade war after negotiations collapsed in late August, with no word on when talks may resume.

<https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/cm1j43y146d2o>

Top themes today: CEC and SIR voter-roll dispute spreading across States, BJP-Congress sparring, trade and sovereignty disputes (US-Canada, Argentina-UK)